

## TIMELINE

**September 15, 1914** Born in Springfield, Massachusetts, the son of a repairman for Boston & Albany Railroad.

**1936** Graduates from West Point and marries Julia Harvey.

**1936–40** Serves as lieutenant and captain in First Cavalry Division.

**1938** Birth of Noel, the first of six children. The three sons become army officers, and the three daughters marry army officers.

**1940** Serves as tank company commander in First Armored Division.

**1941–43** Becomes a lieutenant colonel and commands the 37th Tank Battalion, Fourth Armored Division, Third Army, under General George S. Patton.

**September 1944** Leads Combat Command B in the Battle of the Bulge.

**1945** Receives field promotion to colonel.



**ABRAMS IN THE TURRET OF A TANK, 1945**

**1949–52** Commands 63rd Tank Battalion and Second Armored Cavalry Regiment.

**1953–54** Serves as chief of staff for three corps commands in Korea.

**1956** Promoted to brigadier general and serves as deputy chief of staff for reserve components.

**1959** Promoted to rank of major general and becomes commander of the Third Armored Division.

**1962** Transferred to the Pentagon as deputy chief of staff for operations.

**1963** Appointed lieutenant general and commands V Corps in Europe.

**1964** Promoted to general and named vice chief of staff.

**May 1967** Named deputy commander of Military Assistance Command Vietnam (MACV). Becomes commander the following year.

**June 1972** Appointed chief of staff of the US Army.

**September 4, 1974** Dies of lung cancer in Washington, D.C.